New DARCYS Awards Celebrate Disability Stories in Movies and TV

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On Saturday, Easterseals held the first **Disability** Arts & Culture Awards, called The **DARCYs**, in Santa Monica, California. The awards honor movies and shows that include people with disabilities in true-to-life ways.

Coverage said winners included the drama "The Pitt" and the film "Take Me Home." The published list also named "Horsegirls" as Best Feature and "The Haunting of Pennhurst" as Best **Documentary**. Most judges on the **committees** are people with disabilities.

Tina Frim hosted the night. Geri Jewell received a Legacy Award, and Vincent Rutley received an emerging talent award. Singer Lachi performed. Easterseals Southern California and Film Independent put on the **event**.

Leaders said the awards continue a tradition that began in 1979 and thank storytellers who change how **disability** is seen. For kids who love film and TV, it shows that inclusive stories are celebrated as excellent entertainment.

Word Treasure

DARCYs -- New awards that honor disability stories in film and TV.

disability -- A condition that can change how a person moves, senses, or takes part.

Documentary -- A nonfiction film about real people and events.

committees -- Groups of people who help choose nominees and winners.

event -- A planned gathering, here the awards night.

Background you need

Awards shows celebrate people and projects that a community values.

Disability representation means showing disabled people in honest ways on screen.

Judges often include filmmakers, critics, and people with disabilities.

Break it down

WHO: Easterseals, Film Independent, and award winners
WHAT: The first DARCYS awards ceremony
WHERE: Santa Monica, California
WHY: To honor authentic disability representation in entertainment

Why it matters

Awards show kids that inclusive stories are celebrated as excellent entertainment.

Test what you remember

1. What are the DARCYS?

- (A) A race car
- (B) A math test
- (C) A weather alert
- (D) Awards for disability stories in media

2. Which group helps present the awards?

- (A) Only a grocery store
- (B) A hardware brand only
- (C) Easterseals
- (D) A baseball league alone

3. Where was the ceremony?

- (A) The Moon
- (B) A closed attic with no guests
- (C) Santa Monica, California
- (D) Under the sea only

4. Which Best Feature winner is named?

- (A) A cookbook
- (B) A blank title
- (C) Horsegirls
- (D) Only a weather report

5. Who hosted?

- (A) Tina Frim
- (B) A weather balloon
- (C) A silent robot
- (D) Only a sports referee

6. Who make up most of the committees?

- (A) People who never watch films
- (B) Only sports coaches
- (C) People with disabilities
- (D) Only robots

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: C 4: C 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Nancy Weintraub: Says the awards continue a legacy and thank storytellers changing how disability is seen.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):